

Packet sniffers

Revise 360 lesson plan — 60 minutes

Unit	OCR J277 1.4 Network security — Paper 1, Computer systems
Lesson	Packet sniffers (lesson 8 of the unit)
Lesson ID	ns-108
Experience ID	ns-108
Plan ID	PLAN-NS-L08
Content version	0bf3a99b9ad4
Website	https://revise360.co.uk/experience.html?id=ns-108

Big question, outcomes and success criteria

Big question — How is data captured in transit, and how can it be protected?

Prerequisites

The lesson before this one is ns-107. Pupils should already have finished it: the starter below retrieves from it.

Earlier in the unit: ns-101, ns-102, ns-103, ns-104, ns-105, ns-106.

Assessable outcomes

1. **ns-108-o1** — understand the threat that data interception and theft poses
2. **ns-108-o2** — understand how to identify and protect against data interception

Vocabulary, resources and preparation

Key vocabulary — Data interception, Encryption

Resources

SLIDES	presentations/NS_L08_PacketSniffers_Lesson.pptx
WORKSHEET	worksheets/NS_L08_PacketSniffers_Worksheet.docx
ONLINE EXPERIENCE	experience.html?id=ns-108

Before the lesson

1. Sign in on the **teacher dashboard** (teacher.html) and open **Class logins**. Enter the class or group and the usernames, one per line, then print the login cards. A pupil cannot sign in without one, so do this before the lesson rather than in it.
2. Print the worksheet, one per pupil.
3. Open the slides and the experience once yourself, on the machine you will be teaching from, so the 360 image is already cached.
4. Check headsets or devices are charged and on the school network.

How pupils get in

1. Go to `topics.html` on revise360.co.uk.
2. Sign in with the **username and PIN from the login card**. The class is already set against the card.
3. Choose the topic, then this lesson's card.

Worth knowing before you promise anything. In this build APP_CONFIG.backendUrl is empty, so logins, login cards and progress are stored on the device the pupil used. The teacher dashboard says so too. A pupil who moves to a different machine starts again, so keep a class on the same devices within a unit, and treat the paper worksheet as the record that travels.

Teaching sequence

Sixty minutes including transitions. The online block is the one to move if your lesson is shorter: see the adaptation at the end.

MIN	PHASE	TEACHER	PUPILS	EVIDENCE TO CHECK
0-5	Retrieve	Starter on the board or the worksheet, from the last lesson and this lesson's prerequisites.	Answer the starter on the worksheet.	The starter box on NS_L08_PacketSniffers_Worksheet.docx is filled in.
5-8	Review the starter	Take answers; correct the one most got wrong.	Correct their own starter.	A correction written, not just a tick.
8-18	Explain and model	The new idea in two or three steps, with the example worked in front of the class.	Listen and answer questions about the example.	They can say why, not only what.
18-21	Set up and settle	Sign-in, launch, and what to write before anyone taps an answer.	Sign in, open the lesson, find Data interception and theft.	Everyone is in and on station 1.
21-43	Online: work the stations in order	Pupils read each wall, write the key fact and the challenge, then answer at the badge.	Read each wall, write the key fact and the challenge, then answer at the badge.	The worksheet has writing on it for each of the 6 stations before the badge is tapped.
43-48	Check understanding	The hinge question, hands down.	Answer the hinge question, hands down.	The split across the options.
48-56	Apply	Exam practice on the worksheet, in silence.	Exam practice, in silence.	worksheet, Exam practice a) to c)
56-60	Exit and set up the next lesson	The exit question and the retrieval link to next lesson.	Write the exit answer.	One sentence that answers the big question.

The explanation and the worked example

This is what the walls of the experience say, station by station. Teach the first two or three from the front before anyone puts a headset on; the rest the pupils read for themselves.

1. Data interception and theft

- Data is captured as it travels across a network, without the sender or receiver knowing.
- Attackers can also steal data at rest: from a stolen laptop, USB stick or printout.
- The aim is usually personal details, passwords or company secrets.

Challenge on this wall: Write a definition of data interception and theft.

2. Packet sniffing

- Packet sniffer software captures the packets travelling on a network.
- Network managers use it legitimately to find faults; attackers use the same tools to steal data.
- Unsecured or public Wi-Fi makes sniffing much easier.

Challenge on this wall: Name a piece of software or hardware used for packet sniffing.

3. Man in the middle

- The attacker sits between you and the service, passing messages on.
- Both sides think they're talking directly to each other.
- A fake Wi-Fi hotspot, such as 'Free Airport WiFi', is a common trick.

Challenge on this wall: Why is a fake hotspot so effective?

4. What attackers gain

- Usernames and passwords typed into unencrypted sites.
- Bank details, private messages and company documents.
- Enough personal information to commit identity fraud.

Challenge on this wall: What could someone do with an intercepted school login?

5. Encryption is the answer

- Encryption scrambles data so intercepted packets are useless without the key.
- HTTPS encrypts traffic between a browser and a website; WPA2 encrypts Wi-Fi.
- A VPN encrypts everything between your device and a trusted server.

Challenge on this wall: Why does encryption not stop interception, but still protect you?

6. Other protections

- Don't send sensitive data over open Wi-Fi; use mobile data or a VPN.
- Log off, lock screens and shred printouts.
- Physical security: locked server rooms and cabinets.
- Access levels mean a stolen login only reaches part of the data.

Challenge on this wall: List five things a company could do to reduce data interception and theft.

Retrieval and the check for understanding

Starter — You are working on a train and open your email over the free Wi-Fi. List everything that could go wrong, and what would prevent each one.

Answer space: 3 lines on the worksheet.

The answer is in the teacher answers for this unit, not on this plan: a plan left on a desk should not give it away.

Hinge question

Use this one, hands down, before anyone moves on to independent work. It is a real activity from the experience (ns - 108 - s3 - c2), so the wording a pupil sees matches the wording you say.

Which warning sign might suggest a fake hotspot?

Correct: An open network with a convincing name and no password

What a pupil might choose instead

- A network that asks for WPA2 security
- A network with a padlock icon
- A network named after your own router

Count the hands on each. If more than a few of the class are on one wrong option, that option is the misconception to teach against before anyone goes on: go back to the station this question sits on and work through its example again, aloud, before the independent work.

The course's own response to a wrong answer here: Open networks give attackers the easiest route in.

One response, not four. one response covers every wrong option; it does not say what to revisit for each one, so decide your own reteach for each option before the lesson - the list above is the start of it.

Guided to independent practice

Recognise	11	The answer is on the screen and the pupil picks it: multiple choice, choosing several, matching a pair.
Construct	1	Nothing is offered. The pupil classifies, orders, fills in a table or works a number out, and types or places the answer.

Scaffolds already in the product, and how they fade

- **Hint** is a ladder, not a door: the first rung names the idea, the next shows the shape of the code, the next how it starts, the last animates the technique on different data. A pupil asks for each rung. None of them is the answer.
- **Run** is free and unmarked; **Check my answer** marks. A pupil may run as often as they like, which is what makes trial and error safe.
- **I need help** says to ask you, and says plainly that the question still has to be completed. It does not notify anyone and it does not unlock anything.
- The worked example appears on every early activity and on none of the late ones. That fade is deliberate; it is not a missing example.

Accessibility

- **Read aloud** on every task window reads the task and its brief, with the prescribed values read as values rather than as punctuation.
- Text is 16px or larger throughout, and a question window scrolls rather than shrinking its type.
- Prescribed data is boxed and in a monospace face as well as coloured, so it still reads as code in black and white, in a high-contrast mode, and to a pupil who does not separate green from amber.
- **Lower literacy and EAL:** pre-teach the vocabulary above; let the pupil say the key fact before writing it; accept the key fact in two or three words.
- **SEND:** the sequence is compulsory but the pace is not. A pupil may finish a station next lesson; the progress saves after every answer and reopens at their earliest unfinished question.
- A headset is never required. Every experience works on a laptop or a tablet with a mouse or a finger.

Delivering the online experience

Before anyone enters

- Worksheet out, pen in hand. The rule is write first, then answer at the badge: the first answer is the one that counts.
- Say where the stations are. They are numbered around the room: 1 and 2 to the right, 3 and 4 behind, 5 and 6 to the left, and the final challenge on the floor.
- Say that a badge marked **Not yet** is not a fault. It opens when the station they are on is finished.

The stations, and what to record at each

#	STATION	ACTIVITIES	RECORD ON PAPER
1	Data interception and theft	2	Data interception and theft is...
2	Packet sniffing	2	Packet sniffing means...
3	Man in the middle	2	A man-in-the-middle attack is...
4	What attackers gain	2	Intercepted data can be used to...
5	Encryption is the answer	2	Encryption protects data by...
6	Other protections	1	To protect against interception and theft, organisations...
final	Final challenge: safe or risky?	1	the answer to the station's challenge

Where to pause

Stop the class after station 2 and take answers to its challenge out loud. That is the point where a pupil who has misread the technique can still be put right cheaply.

Afterwards

Headsets off and down. Ask three pupils for the key fact from a station of your choosing, in their own words and not read off the sheet. Then the exit question.

Assessment, evidence and unfinished work

ID	QUESTION	MARKS	WHERE
ns-108-x1	Describe how data can be intercepted as it travels across a network.	2	worksheet, Exam practice a); deck, Exam practice slide
ns-108-x2	Explain why encryption makes intercepted data useless to an attacker.	3	worksheet, Exam practice b); deck, Exam practice slide
ns-108-x3	Describe two further measures that reduce the risk of data theft in an office.	4	worksheet, Exam practice c); deck, Exam practice slide

Expected answers

Model answers and marking guidance are teacher-only and are not printed on this plan. They are in the unit's teacher guide pack, and the per-activity marking for this lesson is in `answers/records/ns-108.json`, which is not published with the website.

Common errors

The wrong options the activities offer are the errors this lesson expects. The commonest to watch for:

- **What is data interception?** — Encrypting data before it is sent; Deleting data from a server
- **Which is an example of data theft rather than interception?** — Packets are captured on public Wi-Fi; A router is monitored by software
- **What does packet sniffer software do?** — Blocks websites for children; Encrypts a hard drive
- **Why is free public Wi-Fi risky?** — It is always slower; It uses more battery
- **In a man-in-the-middle attack, what does the attacker do?** — Blocks all traffic to the website; Encrypts the victim's files

Unfinished work

Record where each pupil stopped, not a tick. They resume at their earliest unfinished question, and a station left half-done is the thing to open next lesson. Do not mark the lesson complete for a pupil who did not finish it: the score screen already shows what was and was not done, and that is the honest record.

Exit, next lesson and homework

Exit check

One of these, written, not a show of hands:

- What data interception and theft is
- How packet sniffing works
- Protecting data in transit

The confidence columns on the worksheet are a supplement to this, not a substitute: a pupil who rates themselves confident and cannot answer the exit question has told you nothing.

Retrieval link to next lesson

Next is ns-109, Defence depot. Use this lesson's big question as next lesson's starter, so the first thing they do is retrieve it.

Homework

Finish any station left open, on the website, from the question they stopped at. If the class has no devices at home, set the exam practice on the worksheet instead and mark it next lesson.

Shorter lessons, longer lessons and no internet

A 40 to 45 minute lesson

Keep the starter, the explanation and the model at full length: cutting those is what makes the online work fail. Take the time out of the online block and the apply phase. Pupils stop where they are; their progress saves after every answer and reopens at their earliest unfinished question, so the next lesson starts there.

If the internet or the devices are unavailable

Teach from the slides and the worksheet. The slides carry the same teaching as the station walls, and the worksheet carries the key facts, the challenges and the exam practice. Set the online stations when the devices are back.

There is no offline version of the experience, and this plan does not contain one. Do not hand out a printed walkthrough of the stations as a substitute: the experiences are used on the website.

Revise 360 — a product of Revise 360 Ltd, created by Olly Pettitt. An independent resource: not written, endorsed or approved by OCR or any exam board. Classroom use and personal study only.